JONATHAN KORSTAD

Applied AI Full-Stack Engineer | Digital Accessibility Expert | Founder

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Mission-driven rapid-learning generalist and Applied AI Full-Stack Engineer with 6+ years building accessible, scalable production software, AI agent systems, and 0-to-1 products across domains often entered with zero prior experience. At Visa, self-initiated and invented **PIN on Glass** (patent awarded to the team)—taking a problem security stakeholders deemed "impossible" during office hours to global deployment across Square, PayPal, and major processors, enabling millions of unsighted users to independently enter confidential PINs. Solo-built **A11y SnapCheck** (enterprise VLM accessibility platform across Visa Global Design), built the **agent benchmarking and regression-gating system** embedded in Visa's enterprise agentic toolchain, shipped a **self-healing accessibility MCP server**, and contributed to **BLITZ** and the **open-source Visa Product Design System (VPDS)**. Outside Visa, bootstrapped **Kynda Coffee** from zero across every physical and digital trade, launched open-source SaaS platforms (**SynapseJourney.org**, **MenuMetrics.org**), rapidly prototyped hundreds of SOTA AI applications, and run **Hermes Agent** daily in production while contributing upstream. **Philosophy:** Whether the challenge is digital or physical, enterprise or resource-constrained—from distributed AI systems to commercial equipment repair and full renovations—approach every problem the same way: understand deeply, learn rapidly, build pragmatically, and ship iteratively.

CORE SKILLS & TECHNICAL BREADTH

- **AI Agents, Orchestration & Evaluation:** Hermes Agent (daily driver; upstream skills, plugins, MCP servers, workflow contributions), multi-LLM orchestration, agent benchmarking & regression gating, failure-mode taxonomy & judge rubrics, MCP servers & tool design, LangChain, LlamaIndex, Smolagents, vision-capable LLMs (Claude/Cline, VLMs), agentic coding systems
- **Full-Stack & Product Engineering:** Python (primary), TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Next.js, Express, Flutter, C#, C++, learning Rust | Distributed systems, REST APIs, webhook architecture, identity management, billing systems, self-serve onboarding & provisioning flows, multi-language deployments, CI/CD pipeline integration
- **Machine Learning, RL & Multimodal AI:** PyTorch, learning JAX, Hugging Face ecosystem (TRL / SmolLM3 SFT fine-tuning), Deep Reinforcement Learning (online/offline, multi-agent), generative & multimodal AI (audio, video, image, vision, 3D mesh/rigging/animation), scalable data processing & automated analysis pipelines
- **Data, Cloud & Self-Hosted Infrastructure:** PostgreSQL, Drizzle ORM, pgvector, Supabase, Beancount | Docker, Coolify, Traefik, Linux VPS administration, Tailscale/tmux/mosh distributed GPU workflows
- **Accessibility & 0-to-1 Builder Practice:** Enterprise accessibility infrastructure & automated testing, WCAG / Section 508 / VGAR compliance, inclusive design for global markets, 0-to-1 product development in resource-constrained environments, cross-functional leadership across product, security, design, and engineering

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Accessibility Analyst | Full-Stack AI Engineer

Visa | 2022 - Present

- **Self-Initiated & Invented PIN on Glass (0-to-1, Patent Awarded to Team):** Learned during office hours outside core role that Tap to Pay planned to launch without PIN entry for blind users because prior teams deemed it impossible against industry security requirements. Over several weeks, independently met with security stakeholders to map constraints, invented a novel approach solving the "impossible" problem, pitched product leadership, and drove it through iteration, user research trials, and worldwide deployment across Square, PayPal, and major processors—the world's first security-compliant solution enabling millions of unsighted users to independently enter PINs instead of sharing them with strangers.
- **Architected & Shipped A11y SnapCheck (Solo-Built Full-Stack VLM Platform):** Built an AI-powered accessibility testing platform (using Claude/Cline and multi-LLM orchestration) that automatically intercepts Figma webhooks, performs vision-capable LLM baseline accessibility analysis, and generates comprehensive actionable reports—including advanced color contrast analysis with brand palette recommendations, alpha-transparency WCAG calculators, URL scanner, VGAR-to-WCAG mapping, and agentic prompt generation for Visa's BLITZ platform. Deployed across Visa Global Design, systematically catching issues pre-development.
- **Built Enterprise Agent Benchmarking & Regression-Gating System:** Designed and shipped the full-stack evaluation system embedded in Visa's enterprise agentic toolchain; scores company agents with and without skills against raw model baselines, flags needle-in-a-haystack misses, false-error fabrication, and missed issues, and gates releases to prevent regressions.
- **Built Digital Accessibility MCP Server & Self-Healing Agent Plugin:** Shipped a 12-tool MCP server, self-healing skills, and subagent orchestration plugin embedded in Visa's core agentic toolchain so agents operate inside automated guardrails rather than only advising.
- **BLITZ GenAI Platform & Open-Source Visa Product Design System (VPDS):** Dual-roled with the BLITZ agentic coding platform team to build secure, scalable agentic coding systems and accessible-by-default prompt generation with VPDS components; collaborated across 3 Global Design teams to architect and ship scalable, multi-language, accessible React and Flutter component libraries for the **Visa Product Design System (VPDS—now an open-source design system)** serving Visa's global product portfolio.

Founder / Owner & Full-Stack Builder

Kynda Coffee | 2019 - Present

• **0-to-1 Physical & Digital Business Buildout:** Bootstrapped a self-funded, profitable brick-and-mortar coffee business from concept with zero prior industry experience while working three jobs through self-paid college—rapidly learning and executing every domain on the fly across business formation, management, barista operations, electrical, plumbing, commercial equipment repair, legal, marketing, and custom Beancount double-entry accounting.

• **Full-Stack Self-Hosted Production Platform (kyndacoffee.com) & Agentic Automation:** Designed, built, and self-host the entire production web stack on a single VPS droplet (Next.js, React, PostgreSQL, Docker, Coolify), featuring an online merch shop, digital restaurant ordering, team training modules, and operational metrics/admin features—paired with a **Hermes Agent** inventory automation system that takes bi-weekly counts, computes exact need-to-order quantities against pars, matches canonical vendor product names, and prepares vendor orders end to end with human confirmation.

• **Built MenuMetrics.org (Open-Source Small Business SaaS, 2024):** After experiencing rapid post-COVID inflationary margin pressure, designed and launched **MenuMetrics.org**, a free open-source SaaS platform helping small cafes and restaurants (including Kynda Coffee) calculate complex ingredient and recipe costs down to the gram with ingredient densities and nested recipes accounted for—capabilities previously locked in paid enterprise software—with early (pre-agentic era) AI business intelligence integrations.

SELECTED & ADDITIONAL PROJECTS

• **SynapseJourney.org — Flagship Open-Source Polymath Learning Platform (Hermes Agent Compatible):** Most comprehensive solo full-stack build (React, TypeScript, Express, Drizzle ORM, PostgreSQL, pgvector, Three.js). Unifies hybrid vector/trigram search, dynamic 1-to-4 tier curricula with resumable learner progress, an interactive 3D semantic knowledge constellation, an Open Science SOTA bottleneck & hypothesis peer-review lab, a strict BYOC multi-provider compute router, and a **native JSON-RPC 2.0 MCP server (/api/mcp)** compatible with **Hermes Agent** for autonomous course authoring and ingestion.

• **Hermes Agent Ecosystem & Distributed Agentic Workflows:** Daily production driver and open-source contributor of skills, plugins, and agentic workflows; built a multi-device Tailscale/tmux/mosh setup bridging mobile, laptop, and a local RTX 4070 Ti GPU workstation for remote agent execution and local inference.

• **Additional Projects & Frontier AI Prototyping:**

– **ForgeDNA & Daggr Pipelines (github.com/Jpalmer95/daggr-pipelines):** Single-schema (game_dna.json) generative 3D game asset pipeline, multi-agent build harness, and MCP orchestration converting text/images into 3D meshes, skeletal rigs, animations, and playable Godot physics environments.

– **GetFreeQuote.org:** Production full-stack customer-facing web application deployed behind Traefik with automated TLS and reverse-proxy routing on self-managed Linux VPS infrastructure.

– **Deep Reinforcement Learning & Model Fine-Tuning:** Trained and optimized multi-agent DRL systems across **LunarLander-v2**, competitive **Soccer**, and **VizDoom** (Hugging Face Deep RL Honors); fine-tuned and published **SmolLM3** SFT models on Hugging Face; built custom Smolagents/LangChain infrastructure automation agents and hundreds of rapid full-stack prototypes across audio, video, image, vision, 3D, and agentic AI as frontier models release.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

• **University of Texas at Austin** — Post-Graduate Program, Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning (2024)

• **Fast.ai / Answer.ai** — Solve It With Code & Practical Deep Learning for Coders (2023 - 2024)

• **Texas A&M University** — B.S., Pre-Med Kinesiology (2019)

• **Certifications (2021 - 2024):** Hugging Face: Deep Reinforcement Learning (Honors), NLP, 3D | LangChain: Develop LLM-Powered Applications | Fast.ai | Cloud, Networking, Machine Learning & Data Science Certifications